

VA Disability Compensation & Pension

If you have a service-connected condition — or low income as a wartime veteran — you may qualify for tax-free monthly payments. Below is how to claim them. Tick the box once you've checked each one.

⚠ BEFORE YOU START

Disability compensation is for conditions connected to your service; pension is needs-based for wartime veterans. Both are tax-free. A free VSO can file for you — never pay for help.

1 Disability Compensation

Tax-free monthly pay for service-connected conditions.

☐ Apply for Disability Compensation

Tax-free monthly pay for injuries or illnesses connected to your service.

→ www.va.gov/disability

☐ PACT Act — Toxic Exposure

If you were exposed to burn pits, Agent Orange, or other toxins, you may now qualify. File a claim.

→ www.va.gov/resources/the-pact-act-and-your-va-benefits

2 File a Strong Claim

How to apply and improve your odds.

☐ Get Free Help From a VSO

Accredited officers file and strengthen your claim for free.

→ www.va.gov/get-help-from-accredited-representative

☐ Fully Developed Claim

Submitting all evidence up front speeds up your decision.

→ www.va.gov/disability/how-to-file-claim

3 VA Pension for Low Income

Needs-based, tax-free income for wartime veterans.

☐ VA Pension

Tax-free monthly income for low-income wartime veterans 65+ or disabled.

→ www.va.gov/pension

☐ Aid & Attendance

Extra pension if you need help with daily activities or are housebound.

→ www.va.gov/pension/aid-attendance-housebound

4 If You're Denied

You have strong appeal rights — use them.

☐ Appeal a VA Decision

Many claims succeed on appeal. A VSO can help you choose the right appeal option for free.

→ www.va.gov/decision-reviews

⚠ WATCH OUT FOR

Never pay a company a percentage of your back pay to file — VSOs do it free, and charging for initial claim prep is illegal. You can also receive VA disability and Social Security at the same time.

★ A TIP THAT HELPS

Even an old or previously denied condition may now qualify, especially under the PACT Act. Talk to a VSO about refiling — toxic-exposure rules have expanded a lot.

NEED HELP WHERE YOU LIVE?

Need help where you live?

This guide covers national programs. For a VSO near you and help with your specific claim, use the personalized AI search or ask in the Questions area.

MY NOTES — WHO I CALLED, WHEN, AND WHAT THEY SAID
